American Sovereign Bullion

The 2026 Silver Report

The Supply Deficit, the AI Demand Surge, and What It Means for Physical Silver



SPECIAL REPORT: 2026 EDITION

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> **When folks ask me where to buy gold and silver, I give them one name: American Sovereign Bullion. They're the only company I recommend.**

Larry Kudlow

Host of Fox Business Network's "Kudlow"

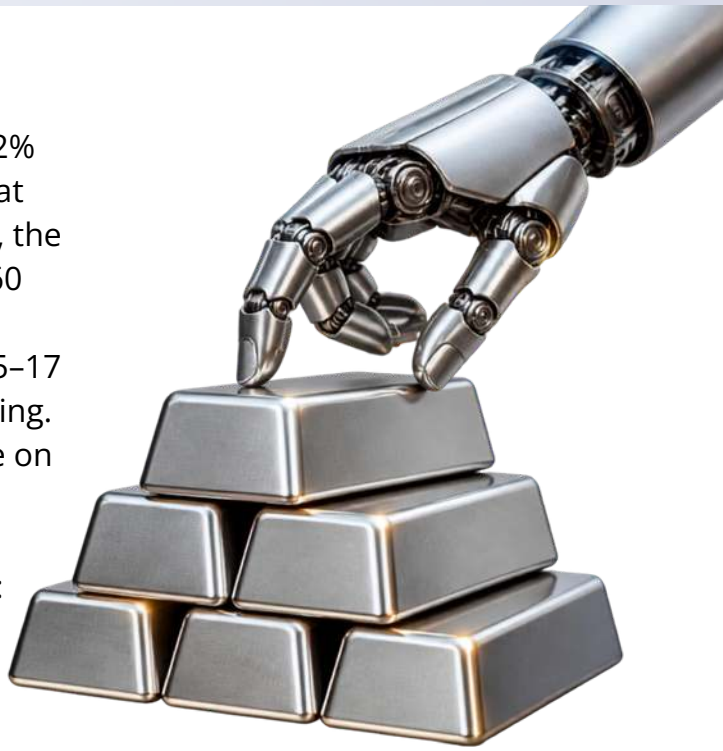


Larry Kudlow is a paid spokesperson for American Sovereign Bullion

Holding silver today presents a multi-layered financial scenario, driven by tight market fundamentals, fiat-currency caused monetary pressures, and a massive push toward high-tech industrial manufacturing.

> **“ Humans, and Artificial Intelligence are requiring more silver every year…than there is**

Silver Supply



The silver’s supply problem is getting worse. Global silver supply is forecast to fall another 2% in 2026, marking the sixth consecutive year that supply has failed to meet demand. Since 2021, the market has already drawn down more than 760 million ounces from above-ground reserves. Meanwhile, silver has surged from roughly $15–17 an ounce to the mid-$60s. The deficit isn’t closing. The reserves are being depleted, and pressure on the silver market is continuing to build.

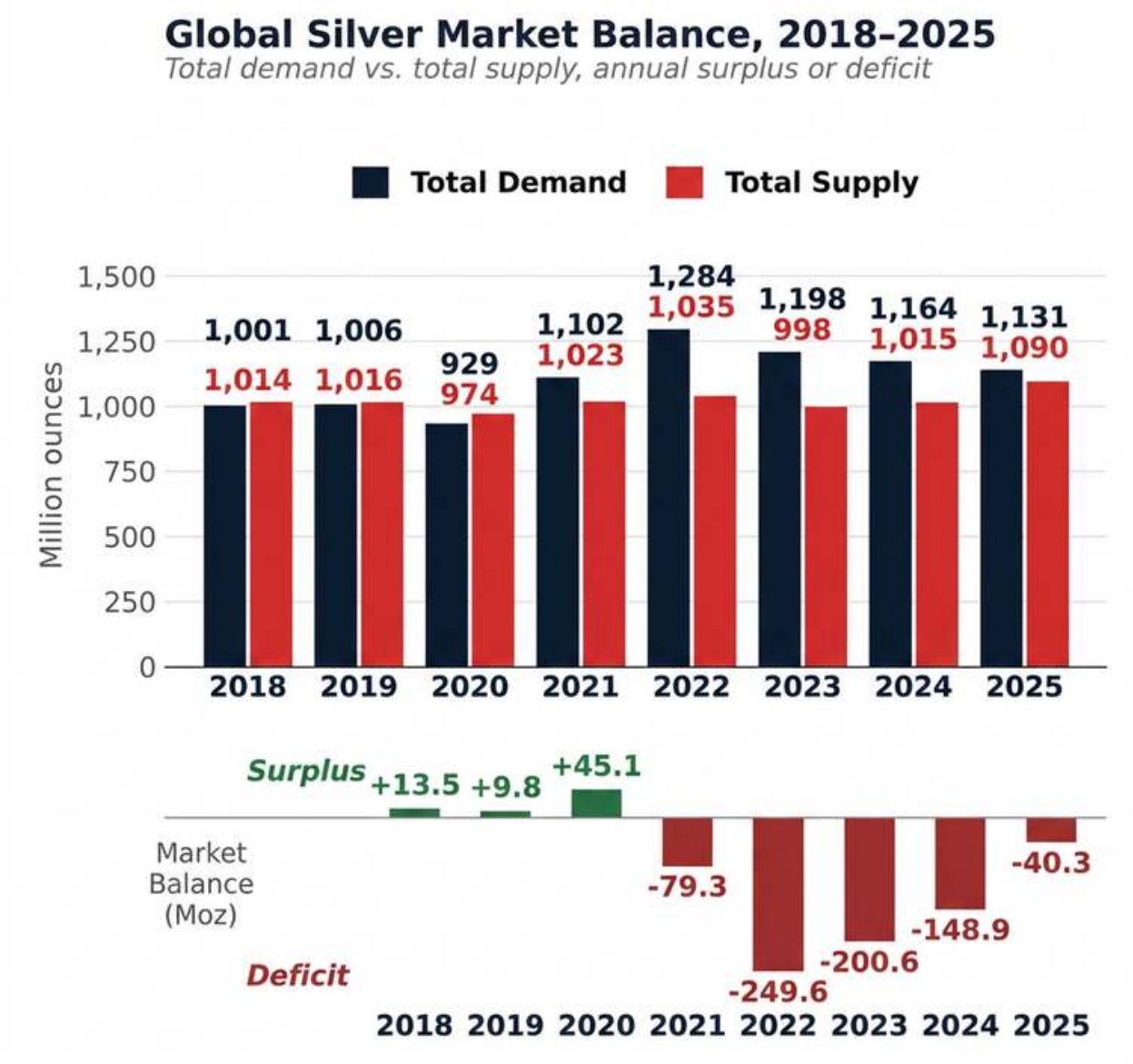
Let’s delve into how fast the world is changing:

Tesla's Production Goals

- **Annual Target:** Elon Musk stated that Tesla plans to build 1 million Tesla Optimus robot units per year by 2030
- ***Each needs about an ounce of silver, 1 million ounces of silver per year rising annually, finishing at an estimated 20 billion Optimus robots***

Silver Demand

This annual survey also includes current information on prices and leasing rates, mine production, silver trade, above ground stocks, and investment. Specifically…





Source: World Silver Survey 2025 (2018–2024 actuals, Silver Institute / Metals Focus, "Silver Supply and Demand" table) and World Silver Survey 2026 (2025 actual, released April 15, 2026). Market balance = total demand minus total supply.

01 CHAPTER

Where Silver Comes From



Silver is found within the Earth, but it was born in outer space. It is extraterrestrial.

Elements up to iron are forged in the cores of stars. Everything heavier is built by rapid neutron capture in violent, neutron-rich events: the core-collapse explosions of massive stars, and the collisions of neutron stars.[3] Heavy metals like silver and gold cannot be made by ordinary nuclear fusion. They require the most extreme environments the universe produces.

Silver and gold are not even made the same way. Research into the chemical fingerprints of ancient stars points to silver forming through a distinct, weaker neutron-capture process in the explosions of relatively small massive stars, roughly eight to nine times the mass of our sun, while gold requires conditions more extreme still.[4] That difference may be part of why silver is more abundant on Earth than gold, and it is a reminder that the two metals are geologic cousins rather than twins.

HOW IT GOT HERE

The Journey to the Crust

When our solar system formed about 4.5 billion years ago, this cosmic material was trapped in the gas and rock that became the planets. It did not stay where it landed.

- **The Core.** While the Earth was still molten, most of the original precious metal sank into the planet's dense iron center. It is still there, and it is permanently out of reach.
- **The Crust.** The precious metal we mine today was delivered later, by asteroid and meteorite bombardment roughly 4 billion years ago, and mixed into the outer mantle and crust.

> *Hence, the silver you would hold in your hand is older than the planet you are standing on.*

That is not a marketing line. It is the reason silver cannot be manufactured. Every ounce that will ever be available to human beings arrived here on a rock, four billion years ago, and the accessible portion of it is finite in a way that almost nothing else in a portfolio is.

"The Squeeze-play"

Does it make sense that if; **A.** Demand for something increases and, **B.** the production of the item cannot notably increase and, **C.** the thing is a 'must have' for companies to exist and, **D.** Demand for the item also historically increases during periods of economic turmoil like 2008-2012- would that meet your definition of ***Attractive***?
Then let's take a look at...



02 CHAPTER

SILVER



Potentially; Major Drivers for Higher Silver Prices

The difference between physical silver held by the COMEX and the amount of commodity contracts trading is the difference between tangible metal sitting in vaults versus paper promises trading on an exchange.
In the silver market, there are vastly more "paper" ounces being traded daily via futures contracts than there is actual, physical metal available to back them up. This leverage creates a unique dynamic that precious metal investors watch closely, particularly ahead of economic crises.

1. Consumption | Physical Silver COMEX Holds (The Vaults)

The COMEX (a branch of the CME Group) does not own silver itself; instead, it tracks physical silver stored inside approved third-party bank vaults in places like New York. This warehouse inventory is strictly divided into two categories:

Registered Silver: This is the physical metal that is 100% cleared, stamped, and immediately available for delivery to satisfy a futures contract. As of August 2026, there are roughly **99.7 million ounces** in the Registered category.



- **Eligible Silver**: This metal matches the required purity standards (99.9% pure) but belongs to private owners, institutions, or ETFs. It is just being stored in the vault and is not available to fulfill market contracts unless the owner decides to sell it. There are about **235.8 million ounces** of Eligible silver.

Therefore, the maximum amount of physical silver immediately available to settle trades on the exchange is only the **99.7 million ounces** of Registered stock.

2. Commodity Contracts Trading (The Paper)

When people trade silver on the COMEX, they are usually buying and selling **Futures Contracts (the Paper)**. Each standard COMEX silver contract represents a legal promise for **5,000 troy ounces** of silver.

Price per Ounce Confusion: Core Argument: The sheer volume of paper contracts creates an "illusion of abundance," decoupling the price from real-world physical scarcity.

To understand the volume of "paper silver," you have to look at two financial metrics:

- **Open Interest**: This is the total number of outstanding, active silver contracts that have not yet been settled or closed out. Currently, open interest sits at roughly 112,000 contracts. At 5,000 ounces per contract, that represents a massive 560 million ounces of paper silver obligations.

Theoretically, if a Consumption event caused pricing for silver to reflect more accurately its mission-critical demand-driven value for it, could the paper traded price mechanics blow up and the double-digit price range never to return, forever priced by three digit prices?

- **Daily Trading Volume**: This is the speed at which hands shake. The COMEX handles roughly $50 billion in notional trading volume daily, meaning hundreds of millions of paper ounces change hands in a single afternoon.

The Disconnect: The Coverage Ratio

If you compare the **560 million ounces** of open paper contract commitments against the **99.7 million ounces** of actual Registered physical metal available to satisfy them, you can see the gap:

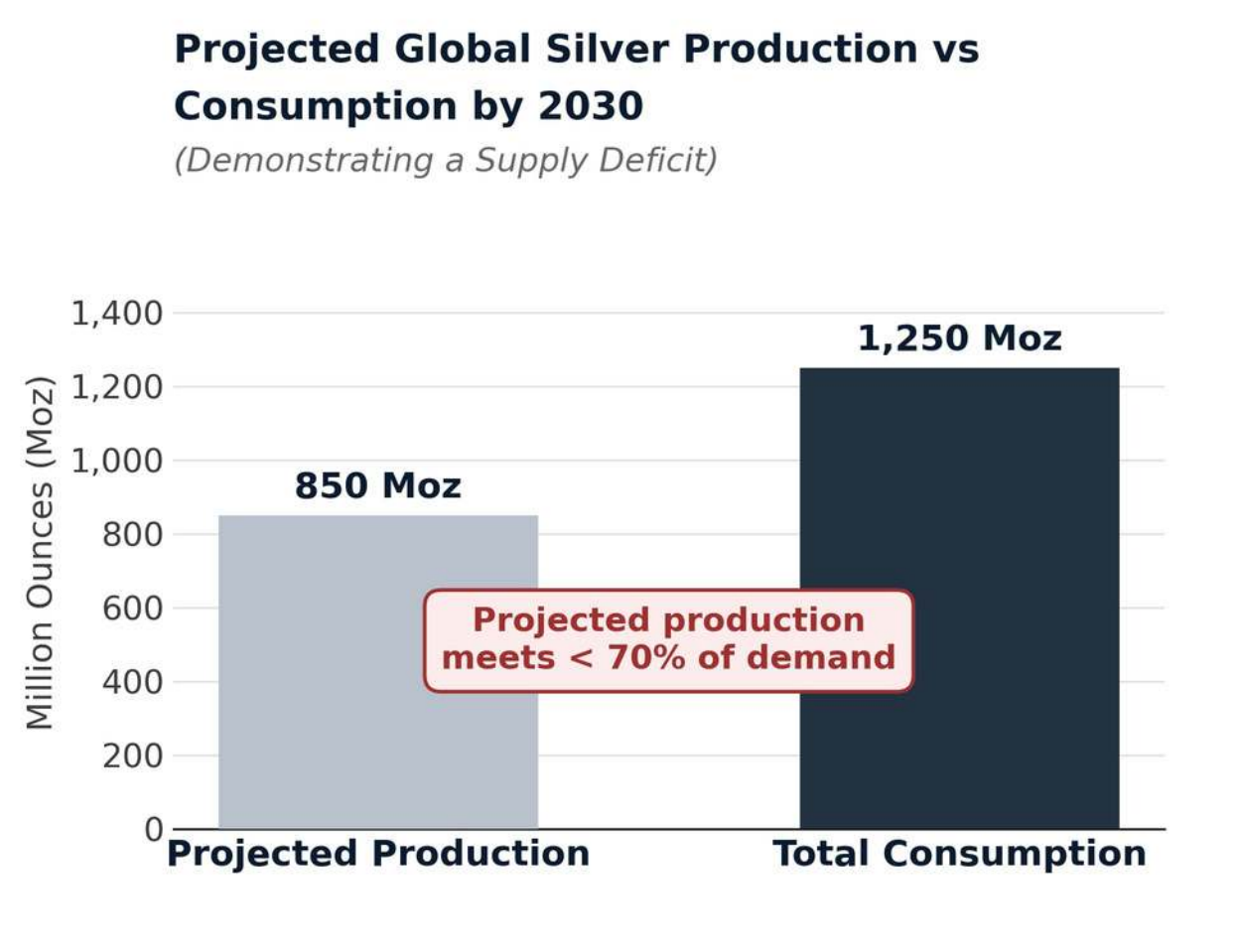
Bank of America's Michael Widmer, the bank's head of metals research, has floated a far more aggressive range of $135 to $309 per ounce, reasoning that the gold-to-silver ratio could compress toward historical extremes of 32:1 (2011) or 14:1 (the 1980 Hunt Brothers squeeze). (Bank of America Global Research, via Kitco News, January 5, 2026.)

By 2030, global silver consumption is projected to vastly outpace annual production, creating a **severe structural supply deficit where annual production may only meet 62% to 70% of total demand**.
This impending squeeze is driven by a massive surge in green technology and industrial manufacturing, clashing against rigid mining constraints.



The Macro Picture: Demand vs. Supply by 2030

Research from institutions like ScienceDirect outlines a widening multi-year gap between what the world consumes annually and what mines can extract:



- **Projected Annual Consumption:** Expected to reach **48,000 to 54,000 metric tons per year** (t/y) by 2030.

- **Projected Annual Production:** Mine production and secondary recycling are lagging significantly, leaving a massive structural shortfall that must be filled by dwindling surface inventories.

The Forces Driving Annual Consumption Increases

Industrial consumption now commands more than half of the entire silver market, transforming silver from a simple precious metal into an indispensable industrial commodity. Three primary sectors are driving this growth:

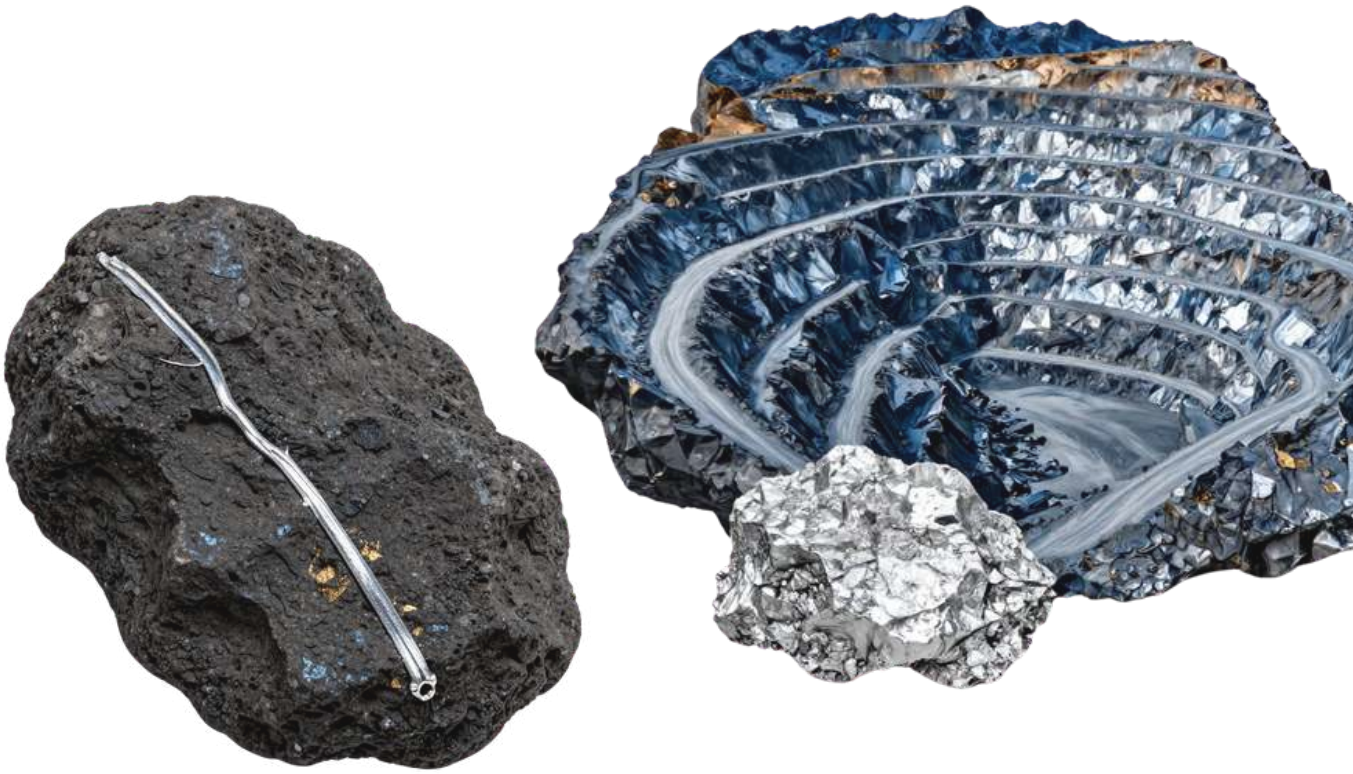
Ask yourself, "Do these three industries seem to be shrinking or expanding?"

- **The Solar Supercycle:** Solar photovoltaic (PV) manufacturing is the single fastest-growing demand source. The International Energy Agency (IEA) expects solar PV alone to devour **more than 30% of global annual silver production by 2030**, up from just 11% in 2014.
- **The Electric Vehicle (EV) Transition:** A standard internal combustion vehicle uses modest amounts of silver, but a battery EV requires **67% to 79% more silver** (roughly 25–50 grams per car) for battery management, power electronics, and charging stations. By 2030, automotive silver demand is projected to scale heavily as EVs take over the global market share.
- **AI and Digital Infrastructure:** The explosion of AI data centers, 5G telecommunications, and advanced semiconductor chips relies heavily on silver due to its unmatched electrical and thermal conductivity.

Miners don't Actually Look for Silver? Why Annual Production Cannot Keep Up

Economics dictates that when prices rise, supply should increase to match it. However, silver mining faces unique structural barriers that prevent rapid expansion:

- **The "Co-Product" Trap:** A staggering **74% of global silver production is a by product of mining other metals, such as copper, lead, and zinc. Consequently, even if silver prices skyrocket, mining companies cannot simply "turn up" silver production without completely altering their massive copper or zinc operations.**
- **Lack of Pure Silver Mines:** Because pure silver mines are rare, direct investment into expanding silver-only infrastructure yields a very small fraction of global output.
- **Lagging Recycling Capabilities:** While scrap recycling helps ease supply constraints, the global infrastructure to efficiently recycle microscopic silver particles out of millions of discarded solar panels and EV electronics will not be mature enough by 2030 to bridge the multi-thousand-ton deficit.



ONE MILLION



AI Data Centers in Space

The rapid expansion of artificial intelligence infrastructure and a global surge in military modernization have transformed physical silver from a traditional precious metal into an indispensable, price-inelastic industrial commodity. Because silver possesses the highest electrical and thermal conductivity of any element on Earth, it serves as the literal nervous system for high-performance computing and state-of-the-art warfare hardware, accelerating a multi-year global supply deficit.



> **“American Sovereign Bullion is the only company I recommend for physical gold and silver and I don’t lend my name to anyone I don’t trust**

Larry Kudlow

Host of Fox Business Network’s “Kudlow"

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Elon Musk's SpaceX has a long-term goal to operate a constellation of up to 1 million AI satellites functioning together as an orbital data center network.

Musk predicts that the company will be launching and operating more AI compute capacity in space annually than the cumulative total remaining on Earth.

The project, part of SpaceX's "Starmind" vision, plans to begin with initial test deployments like the Starmind AI1 satellite developed in partnership with Nvidia, with broader scaling intended over the coming decade.

Project Details

- **Target Scale:** Up to 1 million orbital AI data center satellites.
- **Partner:** Nvidia (providing the compute payloads and hardware architecture).

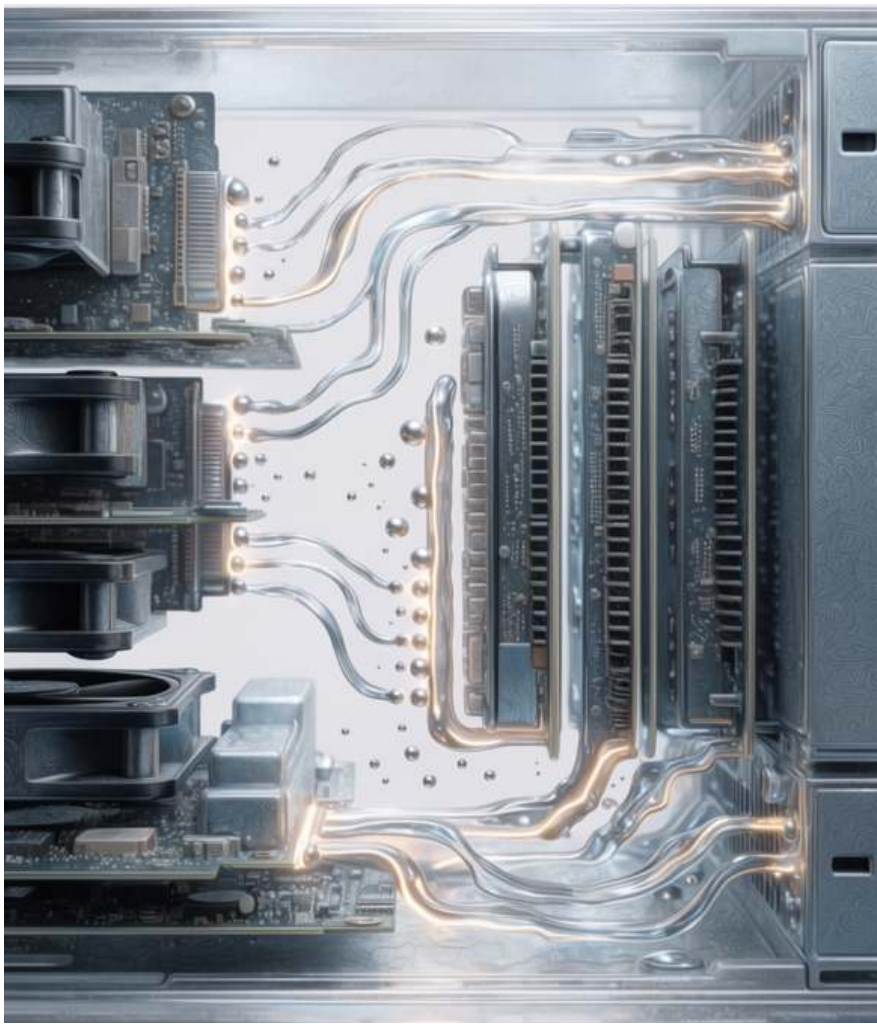
Core Purpose: To bypass Earth-based limitations on electricity and cooling by using continuous solar power and space vacuum cooling for heavy AI workloads.

The AI Infrastructure Boom

Artificial intelligence models cannot run purely on software; they require a massive, capital-intensive physical footprint. Silver is heavily consumed across the entire downstream chain of AI hardware development:

- **Data Center Hardening**: Modern AI accelerator clusters require high-voltage architectures (such as 800V HVDC systems) that rely on silver for electrical contacts, multi-layer ceramic capacitors, and specialized conductive pastes to ensure zero latency.

- **Extreme Heat Control**: Because AI workloads pull massive amounts of electricity (60 to 120 kilowatts per rack compared to 10 to 15 kilowatts traditionally), silver's premier thermal conductivity is utilized in advanced heat dissipation and cooling systems.



- **Exponential Consumption**: Estimated silver consumption stemming purely from data centers and AI hardware has surged nearly fivefold in recent years, escalating from roughly 8.5 million ounces in 2022 to an estimated 41.5 million ounces.

Militaristic and Defense Sectors

Modern warfare has pivoted from mechanical machinery to highly digitized, automated, and precision-guided systems. This technological shift acts as a massive "metals order" in disguise, making the defense industry one of the most aggressive consumers of physical silver:

- **Precision Guided Munitions**: Advanced weaponry from every country, requires silver for optimal reliability under combat conditions. For instance, a single Tomahawk cruise missile is estimated to contain up to 20 ounces of silver in its guidance systems, sensors, and electronic components.

- **Hypersonic & Aerospace Tech**: High-speed drone networks, stealth fighter jets, satellite communications, and hypersonic missiles utilize silver heavily. Its high melting point and flawless signal conductivity are required to prevent data distortion at extreme speeds and temperatures.

- **Global Rearmament:** Led by multi-trillion-dollar global defense budgets and a widespread push to restock depleted munitions reserves, military procurement introduces opaque, non-negotiable competition for physical metal supply.

Strategic Reclassification and Scarcity

The combination of AI demand and geopolitical instability has altered how global governments view the metal. In a significant shift, the U.S. Geological Survey officially designated silver as a Critical Mineral. This reclassification reflects a growing national security priority to secure and stockpile physical inventories amid an ongoing global production deficit.

Because roughly 74% of the world's silver is mined only as a secondary byproduct of copper, zinc, lead, and gold mining, silver supply is highly inflexible. Mining companies cannot simply "turn on the taps" to generate more silver as prices rise. As a result, critical AI hyperscalers and state-backed defense contractors are increasingly forced to compete for a dwindling pool of physical inventory.

The Broad Investment Case

The core investment thesis for silver relies on a dual identity: it is simultaneously an **essential industrial commodity** and a **monetary counterweight**.

- **The Structural Supply Deficit**: According to the Silver Institute's 2026 World Silver Survey, the silver market is experiencing its sixth consecutive year of structural deficit. The projected 2026 shortfall is expected to widen to 46.3 million ounces (2026 forecast). Mine production remains bottlenecked by years of underinvestment, meaning supply cannot easily scale to meet demand.

- **Green Technology & AI Tailwinds**: Unlike gold, which is mostly held as a store of value, roughly 60% of global silver consumption comes from industrial applications. Silver is the most electrically conductive metal on earth. It is an un-substitutable component in solar photovoltaic panels, electric vehicle (EV) electronics, 5G infrastructure, and AI data center hardware.

- **The "High-Beta" Complement to Gold**: Silver traditionally tracks gold's direction but moves with a significantly higher beta. When gold rallies due to central bank buying or geopolitical stress, silver tends to amplify those moves. The gold-to-silver ratio sat at roughly 67:1 as of late August 2026, below its long-run average near 80:1 though still well above the mid-40s low it briefly touched during silver's January 2026 peak, illustrating silver's relative outperformance during this precious metals bull cycle.

- **Institutional Price Projections**: Major Wall Street desks remain highly constructive on the metal's mid-term outlook. Analysts at J.P. Morgan projected silver would average $81 per ounce for the year, but the bank cut that call to $70 per ounce, with a fourth-quarter target of $63, in an August 13, 2026 update. Meanwhile, Goldman Sachs forecasts trading ranges peaking between $85 and $100 per ounce as industrial inventory draws down.



The Retirement Planning Case (Silver IRAs)

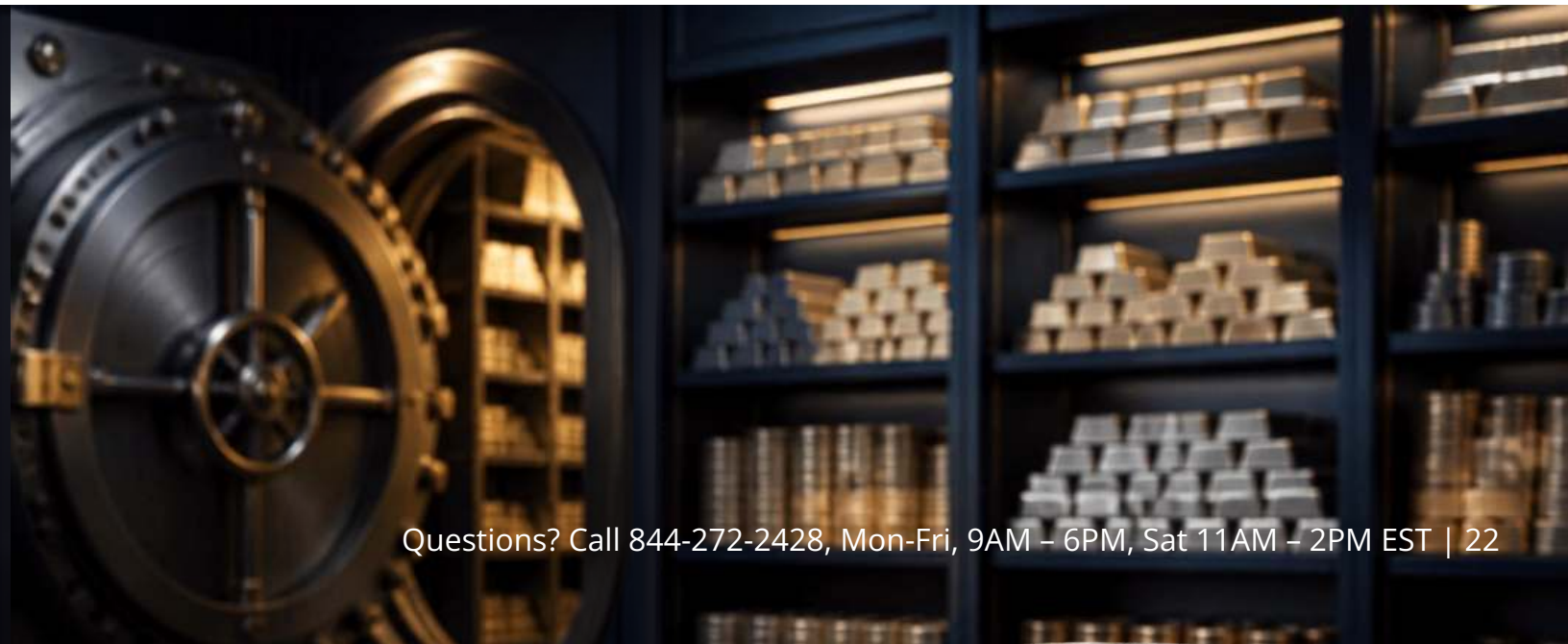
For long-term retirement portfolios, silver is increasingly utilized as a diversification guardrail to counter equity corrections and currency degradation. Investors accomplish this legally through a **Self-Directed Silver IRA (SDIRA)**.

- **The Inflation Positioning Case**: Over a decades-long retirement timeline, cash savings lose purchasing power due to currency debasement. Physical silver serves as a tangible store of value that cannot be inflated away by central bank monetary expansion.

- **Tax-Advantaged Physical Ownership**: Standard retirement accounts cannot hold physical bullion. A Self-Directed IRA allows you to buy physical silver bars and coins with tax advantages:

    - **Traditional Silver IRA**: Funded with pre-tax dollars, allowing your investment to compound tax-deferred until distributions begin at age 59½.
    - **Roth Silver IRA**: Funded with after-tax dollars, providing completely **tax-free growth and tax-free withdrawals** in retirement.

- **Strict Custodial Rules**: To maintain your tax-advantaged status, the IRS enforces rigorous guidelines. You **cannot store IRA silver at home** or in a personal safe deposit box; doing so triggers immediate tax penalties. The metal must be at least **.999 pure fineness** and must be held by an IRS-eligible custodian in a secure depository. Standard approved items include American Silver Eagles and certified Johnson Matthey bars.





Gold and Silver are Inextricably Linked

What Gold Did the Last Two Times Markets Broke

The strongest argument for holding gold in a retirement account is not a forecast. It is the record.



During the 2008 crisis the S&P 500 lost more than half its value from peak to trough. Gold finished that stretch roughly flat, then rose 163 percent over the following years to reach $1,917.90 in August 2011, while stocks took years simply to recover. In 2020, gold gained about 25 percent and set a record at $2,067.15. Zoom out and the contrast sharpens: across the 2000s, the S&P 500 returned roughly negative 9 percent including dividends while gold returned somewhere near 280 percent.

That is the job gold is owned to do, and it did it. Through both crises the metal stayed steady while stock portfolios were cut in half, then delivered years of gains while equities were still clawing back toward even. For a saver holding some, it meant watching one slice of the portfolio hold firm while the rest fell away. That is the whole purpose of owning something that answers to different forces than the stock market, and it is why gold has drawn capital for centuries whenever confidence in everything else has thinned.

Silver Has a Second Engine

Silver deserves its own place here, because something drives it that does not drive gold: heavy industrial demand. Silver conducts electricity and heat better than any other metal, making it essential to electronics, solar panels, electric vehicles, and increasingly the hardware inside data centers. Industrial applications now account for close to 60 percent of total consumption.

That demand sits on a genuine supply problem. Silver has run a structural deficit for five consecutive years and is on track for a sixth, meaning the world uses more than it mines and recycles. Roughly 72 percent arrives as a byproduct of mining other metals, so production cannot ramp quickly on price alone, and new primary mines take a decade or more.

Silver trades near $62 today, above that level for the first time since early July. The gold-to-silver ratio has compressed to roughly 66.5 from near 69 a week earlier, a move physical buyers read as silver reasserting itself. Silver is the livelier of the two, historically able to outrun gold by a wide margin once precious metals get going, with stretches in this cycle where its annual gain ran to a multiple of gold's. That is why many savers hold both. Gold anchors the position while silver provides the horsepower.



How to Put Metals Inside a Retirement Account



Themechanismsurprises most savers,who assume a retirement account cannot hold physical metal. It can. A direct rollover fromanexisting 401(k), traditional IRA, 403(b), or TSP into a self-directed IRA holding physical metal creates no taxable event and no early-withdrawal penalty when an approved custodian handles it properly.

Open a self-directed IRA with an approved custodian experienced in precious metals.

Fund it through a direct, tax-deferred rollover, moving a portion rather than the entire balance if you prefer.

Choose eligible physical gold and silver, stored in your name inside an insured depository and owned outright.

Most savers convert a portion and leave the rest invested as it is. Rollovers typically complete in one to three weeks.

A financial crisis or deep recession can severely impact an American retiree because, unlike younger workers, retirees **lack the time to recover from market losses** and must simultaneously **draw down shrinking assets** to pay for rising living costs.



What This Means for Your Retirement

The "Sequence of Returns" Risk

- **Vulnerability**: Market crashes at the start of retirement permanently damage your portfolio's longevity.
- **Mechanism:** Selling stocks during a market downturn to fund your daily life locks in permanent losses.
- **Consequence:** Your nest egg depletes faster, vastly increasing the risk of outliving your money.

Compounded Inflation and Expense Spikes

- **Vulnerability**: Recessions often trigger unpredictable economic policies or supply shocks that keep living costs high.
- **Mechanism**: Fixed incomes fail to match sudden spikes in healthcare, property taxes, or basic utilities.
- **Consequence**: Retirees are forced to cut back on essentials or withdraw even more heavily from damaged accounts.



Threats to "Safe" Income Sources

- **Vulnerability:** Corporate pensions, municipal bonds, and dividend- paying stocks are not entirely immune to a systemic crisis.
- **Mechanism:** Companies facing bankruptcy may slash dividend payouts or restructure pension obligations to stay afloat.
- **Consequence:** Supplemental income streams that you rely on to bridge the gap can dry up overnight.

Real Estate and Home Equity Erosion

- **Vulnerability**: Home equity is often a retiree's primary financial safety net or backup plan
- **Mechanism:** Property values plummet during a broader economic downturn, reducing overall net worth.
- **Consequence:** Options like downsizing or utilizing a reverse mortgage become much less viable or profitable.



The Bottom Line

The case here does not rest on predicting a crash. It rests on four things already true: central banks buying at record pace with gold now past Treasuries as a reserve asset, a historical record of performing when stock-heavy portfolios suffered most, every major bank target sitting at or above today's price, and silver facing a sixth consecutive supply deficit against rising industrial demand.

What makes the timing interesting is that gold trades roughly a quarter below its January record while all of that remains in place. Would you agree, buying into a pullback rather than a rally is generally the better side of that decision, though prices can certainly fall further before recovering.

Gold and silver pay no dividend or interest, neither are a man-made security, they are from outer space and do not show up as mainstream options so your expectations and understanding need some adjusting is all for why you might consider it in your portfolio.

Both gold and silver can surprise investors as they have in the past risen higher than most people expect, and can decline as well as climb, as this year demonstrated. They belong as one part of a diversified retirement plan rather than a replacement for it. If your retirement holds none of that counterweight, this is a reasonable moment to ask whether it should. This is general information, not financial advice, and the right approach depends on your situation and your outlook.

Holding silver over gold before a financial crisis can be described as an unusual high-risk, high-reward strategy centered on silver’s historical pattern of outperforming gold during the recovery phase and its current severe supply deficit.

However, because you are retired, you must approach this option with extreme caution: silver behaves radically differently than gold when an economic shock first hits.

does that mean you should open up to include an element in your portfolio that is special in the way that it is; 1. Not the dollar, 2. Outside the dollar printed inflated world, 3. Isn’t held in the electronic financial world, 4. Has an incredible history of rising in value during recessions, and 5. Demand exceeds supply.



Your Five-Step Action Plan

Why Advocates Argue for Silver Over Gold

- **The Catch-Up "Elastic Band" Effect**: When a crisis hits, gold usually spikes first as central banks and institutions scramble for safety. Silver often lags behind initially, but once investor momentum shifts, silver historically snaps upward like an elastic band, delivering **significantly higher percentage gains** than gold during the market cycle.

- **A Six-Year Structural Supply Deficit**: According to data from the Silver Institute, the global silver market is forecast to run a **46.3-million-ounce deficit** in 2026. This marks the **sixth consecutive year** where global demand outpaces mining production, providing a fundamental price floor that gold does not naturally possess.

- **The Gold-to-Silver Ratio**: Historically, the price ratio between the two metals widens dramatically before a crisis. Investors who buy silver when it is historically "cheap" relative to gold look to swap their silver back into gold after silver outperforms, effectively multiplying their total precious metal wealth.



Frequently Asked Questions

Is now a good time to buy gold and silver?

No one can time a market precisely. What can be said is that gold trades roughly a quarter below its January record while central bank buying continues at record pace and every major bank target published this year sits at or above the current price. That means buying into a pullback rather than a rally, though prices can fall further before recovering.

How much gold and silver should I hold in retirement?

There is no universal figure. One answer to this question could be, “What are you comfortable with?” rather than what is the ‘right’ amount. However, as one reference point, Ray Dalio has said hard money should represent roughly 5 to 15 percent of a portfolio for most people, specifying gold. That is a general framework rather than personal advice, and the right amount depends on
your timeline, your other holdings, and your tolerance for volatility.

Perhaps today, it isn't about how much you end up holding, it's simply how much would you like to have now?
Is some better than none?

Why are central banks buying so much gold?

Because gold carries no counterparty risk. It cannot be printed by another government, defaulted on, or frozen in a dispute, which is why roughly 89 percent of central banks surveyed in 2026 expect reserves to keep rising. Buying has averaged around 1,000 tonnes a year since 2022, and gold has now passed US Treasuries as a share of global official reserves.

Should I buy gold or silver?

Many savers hold both. Gold is the steadier store of value and acts as the anchor. Silver's industrial demand and multi-year supply deficit give it the capacity to travel considerably further than gold when precious metals run, which is the appeal for investors seeking more from the position. The right mix depends on how much movement you want alongside your gold.

Can I move part of my 401(k) into physical gold and silver?

Yes. A direct rollover from a 401(k), traditional IRA, 403(b), or TSP into a self-directed IRA holding physical metal is not a taxable event when handled correctly through an approved custodian. You can convert a portion rather than the whole account, with the metal stored in an insured depository and owned outright.

YOUR ROADMAP FROM HERE

Your Five-Step Action Plan

If you have read this far, you already understand more about the silver market than most people your age. Here is what to do with that knowledge, in five concrete steps.



CALL

Call American Sovereign Bullion at (844) 272-2428 and ask for the Complimentary Silver Briefing. Mon-Fri 9AM – 6PM, Sat 11AM – 2PM EST.



LISTEN

Spend thirty to sixty minutes with a specialist. Ask your hardest questions. Take notes. Do not commit to anything on the first call.



THINK

Sleep on it. Talk it over with your spouse, your adult children, anyone whose judgment you trust. Take a week if you need a week.



DECIDE

Decide whether a precious metals IRA fits your situation. If it does not, do nothing further. If it does, decide on a percentage that lets you sleep.



EXECUTE

The specialist walks you through the rollover, the depository selection and the metals selection.
When it completes, you receive a statement from the depository showing your metal, in your name, in a vault.



WHERE THIS LEAVES YOU

The Bottom Line

Set price predictions aside and look only at the ledger.

- **Fifty-eight percent** of the world's silver goes into things, not into vaults.
- **Most of what goes into things never comes back.** It is spread microns thick across surfaces where recovery costs more than the metal is worth.
- **Seventy-four percent of mine supply** is controlled by decisions made in copper and zinc boardrooms, not silver ones.
- **The market has come up short five years running**, with a sixth forecast for this year, in a year when five of eight demand categories shrank.
- **The fastest-growing customer on the list** is an industry that did not appear in these tables at all five years ago.

Every sentence in that list is a matter of record. None of it asks you to believe a prediction.

These assets carry real risks. Neither metal pays interest or dividends, silver, fluctuates more than gold, and both belong as one component of a diversified retirement plan rather than a substitute for one.

AND ONE LAST THING

> *Here is the part nobody says out loud. If you finish this page, set the report down, and go back to your afternoon, you have not postponed the decision. You have made it. You have decided that the portion of your retirement held in something outside the financial system is zero.*

That is the right answer for some people. Make it on purpose.

Thirty to sixty minutes. No charge, no obligation. And if a portion of physical silver does not fit your situation, the specialist will tell you so.

(844) 272-2428

American Sovereign Bullion · Mon-Fri 9AM – 6PM, Sat 11AM – 2PM EST



THE QUESTIONS WE HEAR MOST

Frequently Asked Questions

Is this a good time to buy gold and silver?

No one identifies the exact market bottom or top consistently. Silver sits well
below its January 2026 record and above where it started 2025, which means the answer depends on your horizon rather than on the chart. Evaluate valuation, investment horizon, liquidity needs and risk tolerance rather than relying on a single price target.

If the market is short every year, why did the price fall?

Because a deficit is not a price. A shortfall of 40.3 million ounces (2025's actual
shortfall, versus the 46.3 million-ounce deficit forecast for 2026) against 1.13 billion ounces of demand is roughly 3.6 percent of the market, and it is filled from above-ground stocks that remain substantial. Deficits are a slow structural force. Prices move on investment flows, the dollar, interest rates
and sentiment, and those move much faster.

How much gold and silver should I hold in retirement?

There is no universal allocation. A commonly cited reference range is 5 to 15
percent for hard assets, although the appropriate amount depends on financial objectives, income sources, time horizon and tolerance for volatility.

Why are central banks buying gold?

Gold has no issuer or counterparty and can diversify official reserves. Central-
bank purchases may reflect concerns about currency exposure, geopolitical
risk, sanctions and reserve diversification. Purchase levels can change,
however, and should not be treated as a permanent price guarantee.



Should I buy gold or silver?

Many investors hold both. Gold generally offers greater stability and monetary exposure, while silver provides more industrial exposure and typically higher volatility. The appropriate balance depends on the investor's objectives and ability to withstand price declnes.

Can I move part of my 401(k) into physical gold or silver?

In many cases, an eligible portion can be transferred through a direct rollover into a self-directed IRA that holds approved physical metals. The transaction must be completed through qualified providers and in accordance with applicable tax and retirement-account rules. Obtain professional tax or financial advice before proceeding.

REACH OUT

Contact Us

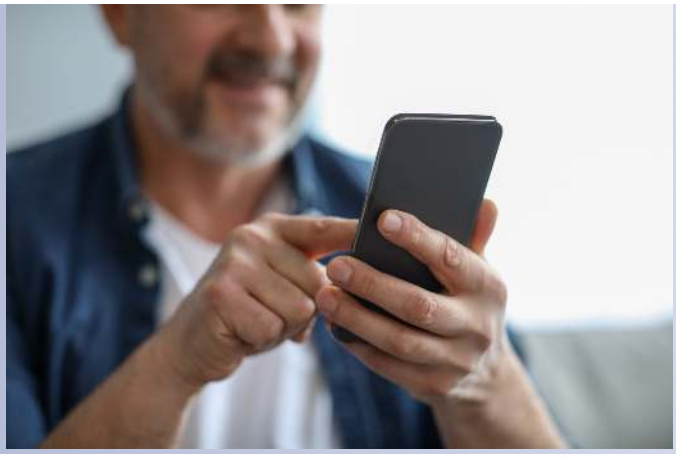
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PLEASE READ CAREFULLY

Important Disclosures

GENERAL

This report is published by American Sovereign Bullion ("ASB") for general educational and informational purposes only. It is not investment advice, tax advice, legal advice, retirement advice, or a recommendation to buy or sell any security, commodity or precious metal. ASB is a precious metals dealer. Its specialists are not registered investment advisers, broker-dealers, attorneys or tax advisers, and conversations with ASB specialists do not constitute investment, legal or tax advice.

MARKET RISK

Precious metals are volatile and can lose value. Silver in particular declined more than 40 percent from its January 2026 record within a matter of weeks. Physical metals pay no interest or dividends, may carry dealer premiums and storage or custodial fees, and may be difficult to sell quickly at quoted spot prices. Past performance does not indicate or guarantee future results.

SUPPLY AND DEMAND FIGURES

Supply, demand and market-balance figures are drawn from the World Silver Survey 2026, produced for the Silver Institute by Metals Focus and released in April 2026, reporting 2025 actuals and 2026 forecasts. A small number of figures in this report are derived by combining two inputs the Survey publishes separately (for example, applying a stated percentage to a stated total) rather than quoting a figure the Survey itself prints; the calculation for each is shown in Footnotes & Sources. The Survey rounds each line independently and revises prior-year data annually.

FORECASTS AND THIRD-PARTY OPINIONS

Price forecasts cited in this report are the published opinions of third-party analysts as of the dates noted. They are estimates, not guarantees, and are frequently revised. Several forecasts cited here were revised during 2026. Readers should verify all factual claims independently.

MARKET DATA

Spot prices and the gold-to-silver ratio are as of the close on August 21, 2026. COMEX vault and open-interest figures are as of August 19, 2026. All such figures change continuously.

TAX TREATMENT

Statements regarding the tax treatment of precious metals IRAs are based on current IRS rules and could change.
Eligibility for a tax-deferred rollover depends on the specific facts of the account holder's situation. ASB does not provide tax advice. Consult a qualified tax professional, financial adviser or attorney before making any rollover, transfer or purchase decision.

FORWARD-LOOKING STATEMENTS

Statements regarding future supply deficits, industrial demand, orbital computing programs and price levels are projections and scenarios, not predictions. They depend on technology, substitution, recycling, economic growth, regulatory approval and mining investment, any of which may develop differently than described. A market deficit does not establish a price floor.

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FOR THE RECORD

Footnotes & Sources

Every figure in this report traces to one of the sources below.

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- Bank of America's Widmer projects silver could reach between $135 and $309 per ounce in 2026 based on gold-to-silver ratio compression to historical extremes (32:1 in 2011; 14:1 in 1980).
- J.P. Morgan Global Research, "Silver Price Forecast for 2026 and 2027," revised August 13, 2026, cutting its 2026 average to $70 and Q4 2026 target to $63. jpmorgan.com
- Citi research note as reported August 2026: near-term (three-month) target $75 per ounce; six-to-twelve-month target $90 per ounce.
- LBMA analyst forecast survey median of approximately $79.57 per ounce for 2026; Reuters poll of 30 analysts, median near $79.50.

- 26 U.S.C. § 408(m)(3). Silver bullion held in an IRA must meet a minimum fineness of .999. Metal must be held by an approved trustee or custodian; taking personal possession is treated as a distribution.

- Tesla's Q2 2025 earnings call target of 1 million Optimus units per year “within five years,” as reported by The Motley Fool and other financial press, August 2025. Per-unit silver content and cumulative unit counts beyond that stated production target are estimates, not Tesla disclosures.

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- Estimates of silver content in a Tomahawk cruise missile are not officially disclosed by the U.S. Department of Defense or Raytheon and vary widely across public sources, from single-digit ounces to several hundred. This report uses a conservative mid-range estimate.

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